

1. Administrative & Study Identification

Full Study Title: A Phase 3, Randomized, Double-Blind, Placebo-Controlled Program to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of Tulasikibart in Participants with Moderately to Severely Active Crohn's Disease **Short Title/Acronym:** A Study to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of Tulasikibart (MK-7240) in Participants With Moderate to Severe Crohn's Disease (MK-7240-008) **Protocol Number:** MK-7240-008 (ATLAS 008) **NCT Number:** NCT06430801 **Sponsor Name:** Merck Sharp & Dohme LLC (MSD) **Investigational Product:** Tulasikibart (MK-7240) **Phase of Development:** Phase III **Medical Monitor:** Merck Clinical Trial Team / Principal Investigator (e.g., Prof. Miles Sparrow for ANZCTR sites)

2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

2.1 Study Objective Primary Objective: To evaluate if at least 1 tulasikibart dose level is superior to placebo in the proportion of participants achieving clinical remission per Crohn's Disease Activity Index (CDAI) score (<150) or stool frequency and abdominal pain score, and in the proportion of participants achieving endoscopic response at Week 12 (induction) and Week 52 (maintenance). **Secondary Objectives:** To evaluate the overall safety and tolerability of tulasikibart over the induction, maintenance, and extension periods.

2.2 Background & Rationale To address the unmet medical need in patients aged 16 to 75 years with moderately to severely active Crohn's disease (CD) who have either not responded to or could not tolerate previous conventional or biologic therapies. Tulasikibart aims to reduce symptoms (e.g., abdominal pain, loose stools, ulcers) and induce long-term clinical and endoscopic remission.

3. Study Design & Methodology

3.1 Design Framework Study Type: Interventional **Control Type:** Placebo-controlled **Blinding:** Double-blind **Randomization:** Randomized

3.2 Planned Enrollment & Duration Target \$\$\$: Approximately 1,200 participants **Number of Sites:** Global multicenter trial **Estimated Study Start:** 2024 **Estimated Primary Completion:** ~4 years total duration (including induction, maintenance, and extension phases)

4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

4.1 Inclusion Criteria 1. Age 16 to 75 years. 2. Confirmed diagnosis of moderately to severely active Crohn's disease (CD) based on symptoms, physical examinations, and laboratory tests, persisting for at least 3 months. 3. History of intolerance or inadequate response to other CD medicines (prior treatment failure).

4.2 Exclusion Criteria 1. Diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis (UC) or another type of inflammatory bowel disease (IBD). 2. Significant unstable co-morbidities or severe active infections. 3. Concurrent use of prohibited immunosuppressants not permitted by the study protocol.

5. Intervention & Treatment Plan

5.1 Investigational Regimen Dosage/Frequency: Tulsokibart (MK-7240) at various dose levels (Study 1 and Study 2 parameters for induction and maintenance). **Route of Administration:** Intravenous (IV) infusion and/or Subcutaneous injection. **Duration of Treatment:** 12-week induction, 52-week maintenance, and up to a 3-year extension period (totaling approximately 4 years).

5.2 Concomitant & Prohibited Therapy Permitted: Stable doses of select baseline CD medications (as specified by protocol). **Prohibited:** Other investigational biologics or targeted therapies for IBD during the study duration.

6. Study Timeline & Visit Schedule

Visit ID	Window (Days)	Key Activities/Procedures
Screening	Day -28 to 0	Informed Consent, Medical History, Endoscopy/Imaging, Lab Tests
Baseline	Day 0	Randomization, First Dose (IV/Injection), Physical Exam
Interim 1	Week 12 ± 7	Efficacy Assessment (CDAI <150, Endoscopic Response), Safety Labs
Interim 2	Week 52 ± 7	Maintenance Efficacy Assessment, Endoscopy, Biomarkers
End of Study	Year 4	Final Efficacy/Safety Assessment (Post-Extension), Exit Interview

7. Outcome Measures (Endpoints)

7.1 Primary Endpoint Definition: Proportion of participants achieving clinical remission (per CDAI score < 150 for US/FDA, or stool frequency/abdominal pain score for EU/EMA) and proportion of participants achieving endoscopic response at Week 12 and Week 52. **Measurement Method:** Clinical assessment scoring (CDAI), patient-reported outcomes (stool frequency/pain), and central reading of endoscopy results.

7.2 Secondary & Exploratory Endpoints * Incidence of Adverse Events (AEs) and Serious Adverse Events (SAEs). * Long-term clinical and endoscopic remission rates during the 3-year extension phase.

8. Safety & Adverse Event Reporting

Adverse Event (AE) Monitoring: Patient monitoring via physical examinations, blood, urine, stool, and colon tissue samples throughout the trial. **Serious Adverse Events (SAEs):** Standard 24-hour reporting timeline for any life-threatening events or hospitalizations. **Data Monitoring Committee (DMC):** Independent external DMC established to monitor safety signals periodically.

9. Statistical Analysis Plan (SAP) Summary

Analysis Populations: Intent-to-Treat (ITT) for primary efficacy; Safety Set for AE/SAE evaluations. **Sample Size Justification:** Approximately 1,200 participants to achieve adequate power ($\alpha = 0.05$, Power = 80%) to detect statistically significant differences between tulisokibart dose groups and placebo in achieving clinical remission and endoscopic response. **Handling of Missing Data:** Non-Responder Imputation (NRI) for primary binary categorical endpoints (remission/response), and Multiple Imputation for continuous variables.

10. Quality Assurance & Regulatory Compliance

GCP Compliance: This study will be conducted in accordance with Good Clinical Practice (GCP) and the Declaration of Helsinki. **Monitoring Plan:** Regular onsite and remote monitoring of trial sites to ensure protocol adherence and data integrity. **Audit Trail:** Electronic Case Report Form (eCRF) utilizing 21 CFR Part 11 compliant systems with full audit trails.

11. Study Identifiers & Governance

Primary ID: MK-7240-008 **Registry Number:** NCT06430801 **Sponsor/Lead Organization:** Merck Sharp & Dohme LLC **Study Title:** A Study to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of Tulisokibart (MK-7240) in Participants With Moderate to Severe Crohn's Disease **Official Regulatory Title:** A Phase 3, Randomized, Double-Blind, Placebo-Controlled Program to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of Tulisokibart in Participants with Moderately to Severely Active Crohn's Disease

12. Clinical Framework (Crohn's Disease Specific)

Primary Condition: Moderately to Severely Active Crohn's Disease
Diagnosis Threshold: Confirmed active CD (symptoms, endoscopy, lab tests) for $\geq$ 3 months
Medical Methodology: Induction and Maintenance Biologic Therapy (Tulisokibart)
Optimization Target: Clinical Remission (CDAI < 150) and Endoscopic Response

13. Study Procedures & Methodology

Management Pathway: Step-up biological therapy post-failure of conventional treatments **Education Protocol (HCP):** Investigator training on CDAI scoring and endoscopic centralized reading standards **Education Protocol (Patient):** Injection/infusion training, eDiary compliance for stool frequency and abdominal pain **Quality Audit Mechanism:** Centralized reading of endoscopy/imaging; source data verification

14. Observation & Follow-Up Schedule

Total Duration: Up to 4 years (including extension) **Onsite Visit Cadence:** Baseline, Week 12, Week 52, and specified extension visits **Remote Monitoring Frequency:** eDiary monitoring for daily symptoms **Checklist Review Interval:** Every 12 weeks for major safety/efficacy checkpoints

15. Sign-off & Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date	---	---	---	---
Principal Investigator	[Insert Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				
Clinical Operations Lead	[Insert Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				
Lead Statistician	[Insert Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				